

7.2 Optical Drives

► **Problem:** Your drive reads data very slowly.

Cause: This could occur if the drive is old, and the laser pickup assembly weakens. It might also happen when the pickup lens gathers dust.

Solution: Get a lens cleaning kit and clean the lens. If that doesn't work, it's time to get a new drive!

► **Problem:** Your CD-RW drive ejects and reloads the disc during operation

Cause: This isn't a problem; it's a mechanism to clear the drive's buffer. All CD-RW drives are provided with some buffer memory to smooth out the writing process. While some drives have a way to clear it out, some aren't provided with any, in which case the drive might pop out the disc to clear the buffer memory.

Solution: Before buying a drive, make sure it has a way to clear out buffer memory. To find out what drives have this feature and which ones don't, ask someone who already has the drive model you're contemplating buying.

► **Problem:** Your CD-ROM drive immediately ejects an empty disc.

Cause: This can be either a software or a hardware problem.

Solution: Certain hardware faults can cause the drive to immediately reject certain CDs. To make sure that it's the drive and not the OS that is rejecting the CD, pull out the data cable from the drive and then insert a CD. If it is rejected, then the drive has a hardware fault. If the problem is with the OS, try disabling features such as auto-insertion notification.

If the machine is powered on for some time and the CD-R was in use, then the resultant heat can at times lead to such rejection problems. The drive might need realignment, and should be given to a service centre.

► **Problem:** A multi-session disc has only the last-burnt data; you can't see data from older sessions

Cause: This happens when you forget to link the data from previous